



Octopus Habitat Security Standard

Mermaid Authority | Certification criteria | Version 1.0

The Octopus Habitat Security Standard (OHSS) sets baseline safeguards for an octopus-managed home that remains submerged beneath the reef. To qualify for certification by the Mermaid Authority, the owner must show that access is controlled, essential habitat systems remain safe, and incidents can be handled. Assess each requirement using current evidence.

Review themes help inspectors focus on a topic. They are optional filters, not levels of compliance: a requirement can have no theme or several themes. Each requirement is part of a specific scope.

1 Access and identity

ID	Requirement	Review themes
OH 1.1	Maintain an inventory of permanent residents and authorized visitors, including the areas each may enter.	Access
OH 1.2	Use a controlled entry procedure for visitors. Record the host, entry and exit times, and review the log at least monthly.	Access, Operations
OH 1.3	Revoke access within one tide cycle when a resident or contractor no longer needs it.	Access

2 Habitat and equipment

ID	Requirement	Review themes
OH 2.1	Inspect and maintain habitat structures and access points.	Habitat
OH 2.1.1	Inspect structural supports, anchoring points and entry hatches at least quarterly.	Habitat
OH 2.1.2	Record and repair defects that could destabilize the habitat or permit unauthorized entry.	Habitat
OH 2.2	Equip the habitat with alerts for strong currents and unauthorized entry, and test both alerts at least monthly. Assessment questions Are both alerts enabled? Single choice: Yes / No Which alerts were tested in the past month? Multiple choice: Strong current / Intrusion	Habitat, Monitoring
OH 2.3	Keep a tested backup power source for critical lighting, alerts and communication equipment.	



3 Monitoring and response

ID	Requirement	Review themes
OH 3.1	Maintain an emergency contact route and a safe evacuation path from each occupied chamber.	Response
OH 3.2	Record security and safety incidents, including the time, affected area, actions taken and outcome. Assessment questions Where is the latest incident record stored, and how can it be retrieved? Free text	Response, Monitoring
OH 3.3	Review every incident within seven days and track corrective actions to closure.	Response

Assessment scale

Score	Label	Meaning
0	Not met	No reliable evidence that the requirement is met.
1	Partly met	The safeguard exists but is incomplete, untested or inconsistently applied.
2	Met	The safeguard is in place and supported by current evidence.

Certification requires a score of 2 for every requirement. A score of 0 or 1 calls for correction and reassessment. Questions within requirements guide the assessment. The requirement and its evidence determine the score.